called Bombay). As it was found very profitable among the farming community it was extended to more numbers in Gujarat. In 1960's AMUL became a very well established dairy society in India. In 1966, Prime Minister Lalbahudar Sastri inaguraged Operation Flood with NDDB headed by Mr. Verghese Kurien. Verghese Kurien became the architect of the programme and gave professional help in bringing this White Revolution in 1970's.

"In 1955 our butter imports were 500 tons per year; today our cooperatives alone produce more than 12,000 tons of butter. Similarly, we imported 3000 tons of baby food in 1955; today our cooperatives alone produce 38,000 tons of baby food. By 1975 all imports of milk and milk products stopped. The import permitted was that of food aid under Operation Flood."

-Verghese Kurien.

Activity

Collect information about Aavin in Tamilnadu and study its impact.

Major Objectives of the Operation Flood:

1. To increase milk production ("a flood of milk")
2. To increase rural incomes of dairy sheds.
3. To provide fair prices for consumers
4. To reduce the import burden on the national exchequer.
5. To establish a National Milk Grid.
6. To meet nutrients needs.

The White Revolution or Operation Flood programme was implemented in three phases. In the first phase (1970-79), 18 of the country's main milk sheds were connected to the consumers of the four major cities namely Mumbai, Delhi, Calcutta and Madras. The total cost of this phase was Rs.116 crores.

In the second phase (1981–85), the milk sheds were increased from 18 to 136 and the city market points increased to 290 for urban distribution of milk. By the end of 1985, more than 43,000 self sustaining village cooperatives with 42.5 lakh milk producers were covered. Domestic milk powder production increased from 22,000 tons in the pre-project year to 140,000 tons by 1989.

Do YOU KNOW?

1. Sir Viswesvarayya who is considered to be a pioneer in economic planning in India was a chief civil engineer, scholar, statesman, politician and the 19th Diwan of Mysore, who served from 1912 to 1919. He received India's highest honour, the Bharat Ratna, in 1955.
2. While the World Milk Day is celebrated on June 1 each year, National Milk Day is celebrated on November 26th. This day marks the birth anniversary of Verghese Kurien, the Father of White Revolution in India.

In the third phase (1985–96), the dairy cooperatives were enabled to expand and strengthen the required facilities to procure and market increasing volumes of milk. Veterinary medical care, cattle nutrition and artificial insemination services for cooperative members were expanded along with intensified dairy farm education. It went with adding 30,000 new

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